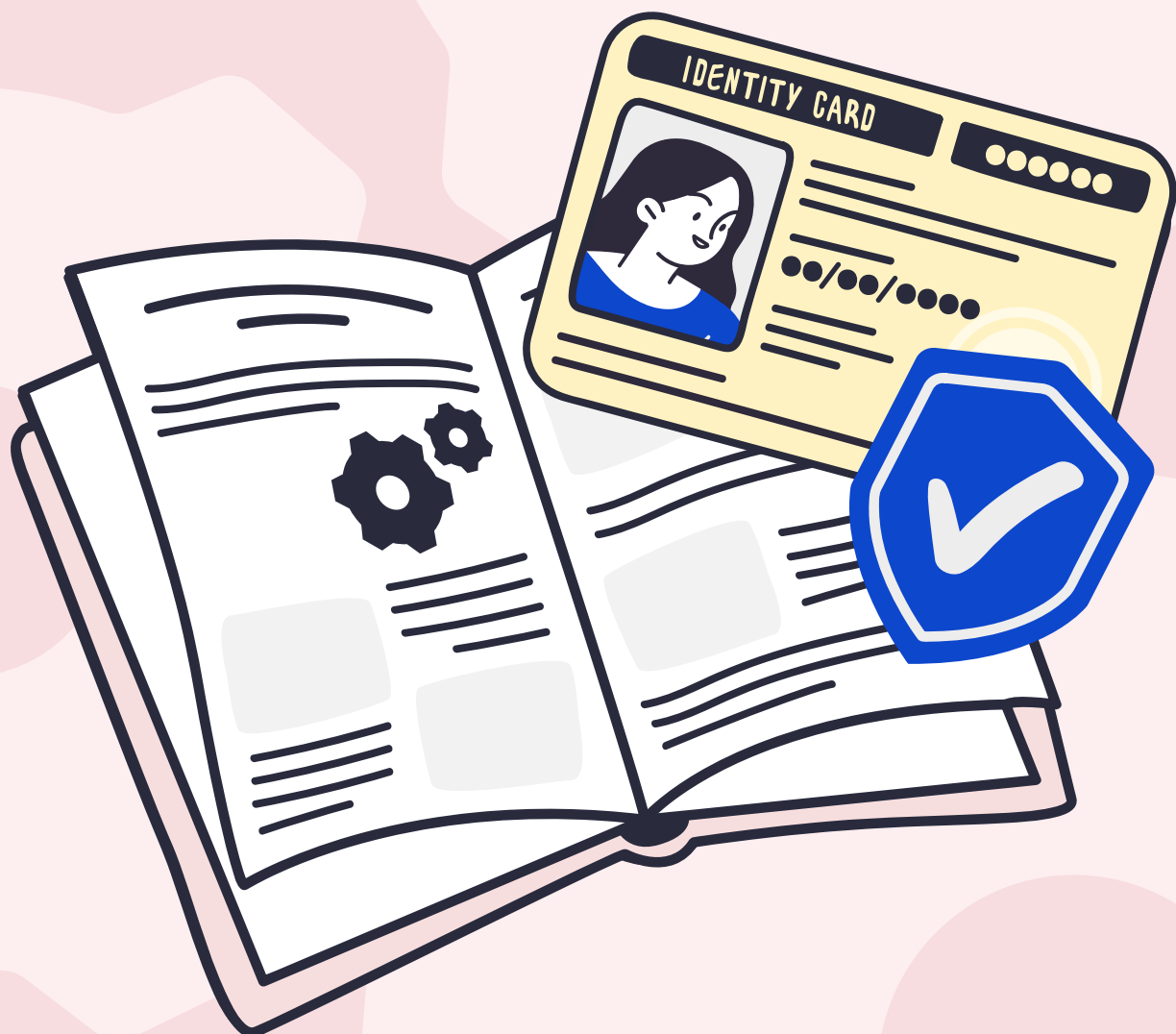


Use Case Manual

The identification in proximity scenarios



A Use Case Manual is a description of a specific use case for the EU Digital Identity Wallet. It includes an introduction to the use case and the user journey, the state of play of the use case development, as well as references to the relevant technical specifications and infrastructures, legislation, and governance structures.

The Use Case Manual is designed for the Wallet implementers, Member States and other stakeholders interested in the development of the Wallet and its use cases.

The Use Case Manual is not intended to contain full detailed technical specifications for the use case. However, where such specifications are available, the Use Case Manual contains pointers to them.

Description

In this use case, relying parties are utilizing EUDI Wallets to identify users in proximity scenarios. Relying parties' objectives may include allowing access to premises to only authorised users, law enforcement, airports or hotels registering the identity of the person they are dealing with, pharmacies checking the identity of a person to see if they have a prescription, shops checking the identity of a person to see if they are authorised to get access to a service or benefits etc.

It builds on the same PID, and electronic attestation of attributes framework defined in the European Digital Identity Regulation and the EUDI Wallet Architecture Reference Framework (ARF), but adapts it to short-range, offline-capable communication channels. In order to enable proximity identification, it is expected that the document would need to include a photo, which per PID rulebook1 falls under the portrait attribute in optional attributes specified in Implementing Regulation (EU) 2024/2977 in ARF, however, the mandatory use of photo ID in proximity scenarios remains unclear at the point of writing.

The important emphasis is that the EUDI Wallet should be able to perform identification no matter if the EUDI Wallet itself is online or offline (identification may work even without internet access), as it was the case in the Potential use case UC 1.1, *Identification in Close Proximity Scenario*.

This use case gives citizens the ability to use their EUDI Wallet for **face-to-face interactions with relying parties**, where the transaction requires strong assurance of identity. Instead of presenting physical identity documents, employment badges or loyalty cards, users can present document from their EUDI Wallet using secure device-to-device communication protocols. Deployment of this use case currently depends on national legal frameworks and on the voluntary acceptance by relying parties.

There are two separate scenarios for proximity identification, supervised, where user and their device are close to the service provider, for example at a public administration office or a bank, or unsupervised (with a machine), the user interacts with a machine such as a terminal or a self-service kiosk to retrieve the keys of a rented car for example, instead of a person.

User Journey(s)

Supervised

1. User holds a valid digital ID document with photo attribute
2. At check-in, the hotel receptionist request identification through a verifier device
3. The user opens the EUDI Wallet on a smartphone and scans the QR code
4. User reviews the request and consents to share the required data, for example:
 - Name
 - Date of birth
 - Nationality
 - Photo
5. The user confirms the disclosure with PIN or biometric authentication

- 6. The verifier’s device validates the proof locally, and shows document’s picture to verifier to confirm
- 7. Verifier confirms the identity and continues with check in process

Unsupervised

- 1. User holds a valid digital ID document with photo attribute
- 2. At the airport, user walks to the automatic security doors
- 3. Security door’s screen prompt user to scan the document at the gate scanner
- 4. User opens the EUDI Wallet and opens the document’s code and presents it to scanner
- 5. EUDI Wallet verifies the authenticity of relying party
- 6. User reviews the request and confirms the disclosure of data
- 7. EUDI Wallet authenticates the user
- 8. The security doors identify the citizen and authenticate the presentation
- 9. Citizen is granted access through the doors

Use case impact

This capability is essential for real-world in-person identifications with physical presence, such as at airports, hotels, pharmacies, police checks, or public offices. It offers a digital alternative to presenting physical documents like ID cards, driving licences, or insurance cards, while preserving user control of data.

Benefits

End-user/citizen value

For citizens, proximity identification replaces the need to present physical documents for in-person purchases of goods and services, from renting a car to proving age in a store. It provides a faster, more private way to verify identity, while ensuring that users remain in full control of the attributes they disclose. This builds digital trust and transparency.

- *Convenience:*
Citizens can use their EUDI Wallet instead of carrying and presenting physical ID documents.
- *Selective disclosure:*
Only the strictly necessary attributes are shared (e.g., “18+” instead of date of birth).
- *Offline usability:*
Works without internet or mobile network, useful in rural areas or while travelling.
- *Trust in relying party:*
They will always share data only with relying parties that are registered.
- *Transparency*
A transaction history in the EUDI Wallet allows oversight of all past identification transactions.

Value for service providers

For private entities such as retailers, hotels, mobility companies, and rental services, EUDI Wallet-based proximity identification simplifies and accelerates in-person verification. It reduces the administrative burden of checking physical IDs, cuts fraud and misuse risks, and support regulatory compliance (e.g. age verification, AML).

- *Speed and efficiency:*
Faster in-person verification compared to manual ID checks.
- *Fraud reduction:*
Cryptographic proofs minimise risks of forged or stolen identity documents.
- *Lower operational burden:*
Reduces manual document inspection and associated errors.
- *Regulatory compliance:*
Supports age verification, KYC, and AML requirements in regulated sectors.

Value for public authorities

Public authorities gain reliable, secure, and efficient tools for in-person verification. Law enforcement, border management, and local government offices can use verifier apps to authenticate citizens instantly and with high assurance, even in offline scenarios. This reduces fraud, supports mutual recognition across borders, and ensures accountability through auditable transaction histories. Authorities also benefit from advancing EU-wide digitalisation targets by fostering adoption of secure, digital-first services.

- *Instant verification:*
Enables quick identity checks by police, border agents, or local officials.
- *Forgery prevention:*
Cryptographically secured credentials protect against fake IDs and impersonation.
- *Cross-border recognition:*
Can be used across Member States once mutual recognition is implemented.
- *Auditability:*
Verification flows can be logged and audited for accountability and oversight.
- *Digitalisation progress:*
Contributes to EU policy goals for secure, digital-first public service delivery.

Economic value and potential market size

Users

The potential user base is essentially all EU residents holding a EUDI Wallet, in total to be hundreds of millions once national rollouts mature. This functionality promises to replace the need to carry and present multiple physical ID documents with a single, privacy-preserving digital alternative usable both online and offline.

Issuers

The primary issuers of electronic attestations of attributes for proximity scenarios are national identity authorities, ministries of interior, or qualified trust service providers (QTSPs) designated under the European Digital Identity Framework. In most Member States, issuance is expected to align with existing national eID ecosystems, such as digital ID cards, mobile ID apps, or population registries, that are extended to produce interoperable, EUDI Wallet compatible credentials.

Relying Parties

Across Europe, there are more than 200,000 hotels and 10,000 car rental locations, many of which conduct in-person ID checks or check-in processes. As proximity identification scales, these organisations will be able to replace manual inspection of documents with cryptographically secured, standardised digital proofs, reducing fraud and operational costs, streamlining their service and make the experience more pleasant.

Transactions

Transactions in proximity identification cover a wide spectrum, from frequent, low-friction checks to high-value interactions. In border control, hundreds of millions of crossings occur annually within the Schengen Area, many of which involve ID checks. In retail, millions of daily purchases involve age-restricted goods such as alcohol or tobacco. In hospitality and travel, hotel check-ins, flight boarding, and car rentals collectively represent tens of millions of yearly ID verifications across the EU.

The total transaction volume for proximity identification is therefore expected to reach into the hundreds of millions annually in the short term, with potential to scale to billions once adoption is widespread across Member States and sectors.

Synergies with other use cases

Further benefits from the use of the wallet for Educational Credentials can be achieved through synergy with the following use cases:

- PID-based identification in online services
- Age Verification
- Ticket or Pass
- Mobile Driving Licence (MDL)

Use case implementation

Existing implementations

The most concrete reference is the mobile Driving Licence (MDL), defined in ISO/IEC 18013-5, which has been piloted in multiple EU countries (e.g., Germany, the Netherlands, Finland) and tested in EU large-scale pilots such as POTENTIAL and NOBID. These implementations demonstrate the feasibility of short-range verification via NFC or Bluetooth, supervised and unsupervised flows, and offline capability.

Other proximity-related pilots under the EUDI Large Scale Pilots (LSPs) have included hotel check-ins, retail age verification, and border control experiments. These projects have validated that proximity

flows can be implemented consistently across different EUDI Wallet apps and verifier systems, highlighting both interoperability and user experience requirements.

Legislation

At this stage, there is no separate EU legal act dedicated solely to proximity identification. Instead, the legal foundation is embedded within the broader European Digital Identity Framework. These acts define:

- The requirement for EUDI Wallets to support identification and authentication across both online and offline scenarios.
- The role of relying party certificates and trusted lists to authenticate verifiers in proximity flows.
- Obligations for Member States to issue and recognise EUDI Wallets until 2026.

Technical specifications, software libraries and infrastructure

Proximity identification must follow the ARF flows for in-person verification. The ARF defines two proximity modes, supervised (human operator present) and unsupervised (kiosk/terminal), while it explicitly supports near-proximity transport (NFC/BLE) with online or offline connectivity on either side.

Data model, format and proof mechanisms

Proximity checks typically present PID attributes (e.g., name, date of birth, or derived claims like “18+”) or other attestations, with selective disclosure enforced by the EUDI Wallet.

Proof and transport options:

- ISO proximity (mdoc) for device-to-device: the ARF and EUDI Wallet reference code support ISO/IEC 18013-5 (mdoc over NFC/BLE) for proximity presentation; remote presentation profiles use ISO/IEC 18013-7 / ISO 23220-4 constraints where applicable.
- OpenID profiles for request/response: for remote or blended flows, EUDI Wallet uses OpenID for Verifiable Presentations (OID4VP) and SIOPv2, with EUDI Wallet constraints aligned to ISO 18013-7 / 23220-4 where relevant. OpenID for Verifiable Credential Issuance (OID4VCI) is used to issue the credentials that will later be presented in proximity.

Issuance

Issuer (e.g., population registry/ministry or designated TSP) issue the electronic attestations of attributes that will be shown in proximity.

Use OID4VCI (EUDI profile) to deliver credentials into the EUDI Wallet (PID and any derived/sectoral attestations). The same issued credential can be presented either proximity (ISO/IEC 18013-5) or remote (OID4VP) depending on the scenario.

Verification

Before any disclosure, the EUDI Wallet must verify the relying parties’ authenticity (RP request is signed; RP certificate chains to a trusted CA in the wallet). The ARF sets explicit steps for signature/certificate validation and revocation checks.

The EUDI Wallet releases only the requested, necessary attributes, preserving data minimisation for in-person checks.



European
Commission



EU Digital Identity
Wallet